



Photo Credit: Sunoj Joshi-UNDP

Two-roomed, Brick in Cement Masonry (BMC) house reconstructed by Mrs. Eet Maya Nepali in Bhimeshwor Urban Municipality, Ward No. 8, Dolakha. Identified by NRA as a vulnerable beneficiary, Mrs. Nepali was able to complete the house with material and socio-technical support from UNDP. The total cost of reconstruction is NPR 550,000 (Government grant: 300,000 and UNDP support: 250,000). [Read the full story.](#)

This monthly bulletin of January 2020 covers a short [video story](#) focusing on the urban reconstruction challenges. In addition, the bulletin highlights featured technical staff person, [NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building grant disbursement data](#), important NRA notices on [call for papers](#) and [deadline extension for grant disbursement](#), national events that took place in the month of January, District and Municipal updates, successful case studies on retrofitting and vulnerable beneficiary reconstructing her own house, media coverage and communication in reconstruction including HRRP and NRA products among others.



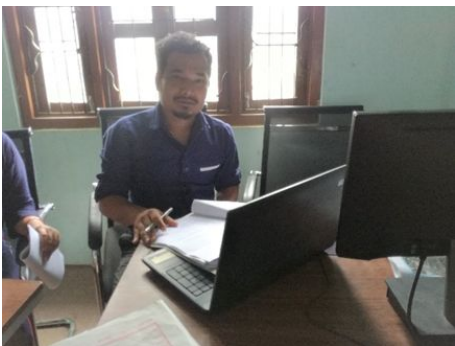
HIGHLIGHTS

- Important NRA notices on call for paper and deadline extension for grant disbursement
- National Symposium on earthquake safety day
- Thematic workshop on livelihood and economic development in post-earthquake reconstruction and Governance, Institutional Development, Financing Rescue and Relief
- 22nd Earthquake safety day marked with various activities
- Updates from Urban Recovery- Technical Working Group (UR-TWG)
- Updates from Retrofitting Working Group (RWG)
- Updates from Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG)

PHOTO FEATURE

	
<i>Ward 5, Bagmati Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: Load bearing stone in mud mortar, RCC horizontal bands and vertical reinforcements provided, two rooms, light CGI sheet.</i>	<i>Ward 8, Ramechhap Municipality, Ramechhap: two storey stone in mud mortar with attic. The house is currently being retrofitted by UNOPS/Build Change as a demo house.</i>

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF PERSON

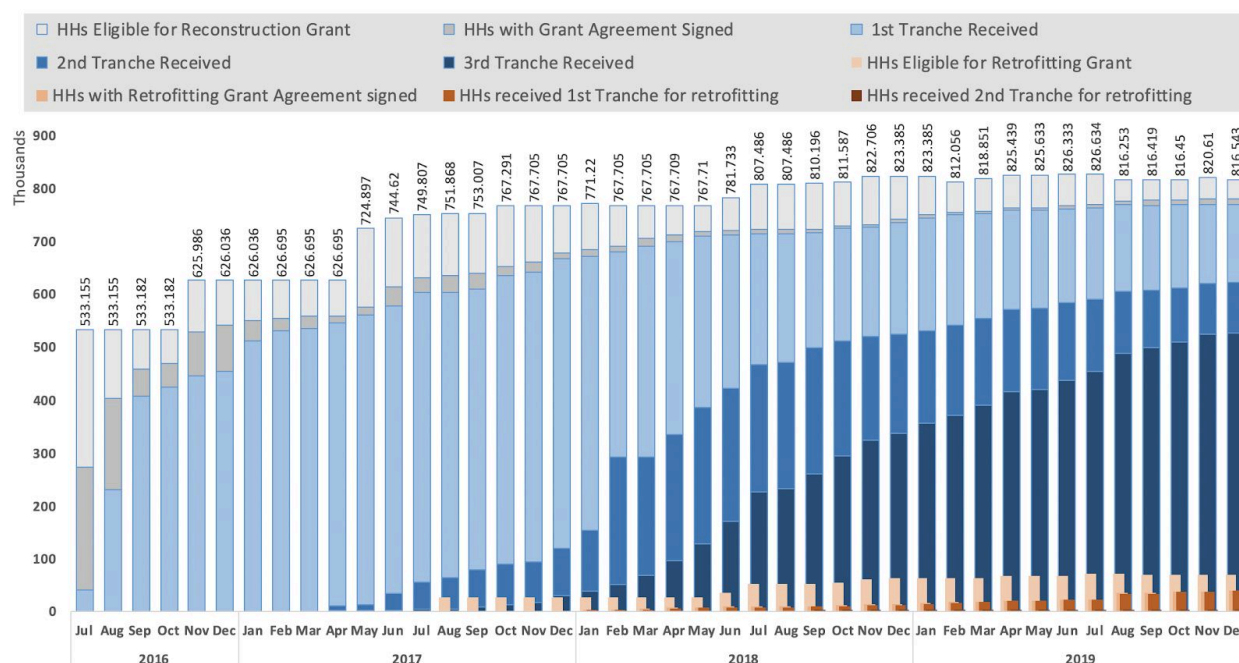
 Shrawan KC <i>Focal Engineer, Bhimeshwar Municipality, Arghakhanchi</i>	This month's featured technical staff person is Mr. Sharwan KC. He has been working as an NRA Engineer since April 2016. He is currently a focal engineer in Arghakhanchi district. Prior to this, he worked at Bhimeshwar Municipality, Dolakha and Chhatradev Rural Municipality in Arghakhanchi. He shares his experience working in both, the highly and moderately earthquake affected districts. He feels that the priority given to reconstruction by the local authorities and the level of awareness among the people is higher in Dolakha than Arghakhanchi. In Arghakhanchi, local authorities are less focused on reconstruction programs. He is one of the few engineers who has been involved in the reconstruction work since the very beginning of the earthquake reconstruction programme launched
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	by the Government of Nepal. He has been working in close coordination with numerous organizations in the districts for building not just earthquake resistant houses, but also resilient communities.
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NATIONAL UPDATES

[RA, CLPIU GMAI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 27 January 2020:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	25 November	30 December	27 January
Total No. Eligible HHs	820610	816543	827358
HHs Enrolled	779725	780803	779125
HHs Received 1st Tranche	768632	769929	770861
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	632558	637348	639554
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	618928	622930	627909
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	3896	3223	3188
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	542193	549740	553777
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	523208	526968	532805
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	2133	1941	1949
Houses Completed	480246	481761	482794
HHs with Completion Certificate	47486	60859	77338
Retrofit Grant	25 November	30 December	27 January
Total No. Eligible HHs	69613	69614	74678
HHs Enrolled	37224	38101	38399
HHs Received 1st Tranche	36491	37668	37872
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	31	34	36



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMAI CLPIU data as of 27 January 2020.

Call for Papers: The National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) has called for the submission of the research papers from interested authors and institutions in preparation for its upcoming International Conference on Nepal's Reconstruction aimed at sharing Nepal's lessons on the post earthquake reconstruction that is planned for 27-29 November 2020 in Kathmandu Nepal. The authors are kindly requested to submit their abstract papers on the following thematic area namely: private housing; cultural heritage; social infrastructure (education & health institutions) and public buildings; livelihood and economic development; rescue and relief; governance, institutional development and financing of reconstruction works by 7 February 2020 to the following email address: conference@nra.gov.np or reconstnra@gmail.com For more guidelines and other necessary information, please refer to following [website](#) or contact Mr. Manohar Ghimire, Under Secretary, (9848126559) email: mghimire@nra.gov.np

Deadline extended for grant disbursement

Sn	Description	Tranche details	Deadline
1	Beneficiaries listed for housing grant but have not received 1st tranche and are committed to reconstruct their houses are kindly requested to take their GoN grant upon recommendation by local authorities	1st tranche	Mid Jan 2020
		2nd tranche	Mid Feb 2020
2	Beneficiaries who have not taken 2nd tranche within mid November 2019 (2076/07/30)	2nd tranche	Mid Feb 2020
3	Beneficiaries of integrated settlement, those needed to be resettled, landless beneficiaries, those living in vulnerable areas, Beneficiaries in Kathmandu valley, and those who would be registered after the latest re-survey.	Registration in grant list	Mid Jan 2020
		1st tranche	Mid Feb 2020
		2nd tranche	Mid May 2020
		3rd tranche	Mid July 2020
3	Retrofitting beneficiaries	1st tranche	Mid Feb 2020
		Last tranche	Mid July 2020

For additional information: Toll free number:1660-01-72000 / 980157211

National Symposium on Earthquake Safety Day, 27 January 2020: National symposium on Earthquake Safety Day with the theme “Earthquake Risk Reduction and Management in Nepal”, was organized at hotel Himalaya in Lalitpur. The symposium was organized with panel discussions highlighting the current status, challenges and wayforward on various thematic issues of building code implementation in Nepal, post-earthquake reconstruction, and future direction of disaster risk reduction and management in Nepal.



An update on Vulnerable Support Working Group Meeting: Following up on the decisions of VSWG meeting held on 23 December, HRRP conducted partners visit from 22-23 January for information collection on the status of housing reconstruction progress by the vulnerable beneficiaries. HRRP met with several organizations and requested for the latest housing reconstruction progress updates to conduct analysis and support NRA and partners for policy decisions in support of the housing reconstruction of vulnerable beneficiaries. A work plan focusing on supporting the vulnerable households for targeted

socio-technical assistance is being developed and will be facilitated during the social mobilizers training. This will further be integrated in the monthly work plan of the social mobilizers. For any additional information, contact Ruplal Aidi, National Coordination Officer: nco2@hrrpnepal.org

22nd Earthquake Safety Day observed, 16 January 2020: Every year Nepal marks 16 January as Earthquake Safety Day (ESD) in commemoration of the 1934 earthquake with various activities. The theme for this year's ESD was "Resilient infrastructures for sustained happiness and prosperity." Bhaktapur Municipality hosted a national event in Bhaktapur. Various other activities at the district level were organized to observe ESD throughout Nepal as a collaborative effort to raise awareness on earthquake safety and to have better preparedness. This included earthquake memorial meeting, earthquake safety rally, national meeting, nationwide safety drills, exhibitions, street dramas and a national symposium. HRRP participated in various events at national as well as district level programs including the earthquake safety exhibition. Home Minister, Mr. Ram Bahadur Thapa (Badal) inaugurated the ESD and visited the earthquake exhibition stalls at Rastriya Sava Griha. He emphasized the importance of enforcing the National Building Code, and highlighted that the amended National Building Code will be implemented through urban and rural municipalities at the local level.



NSET Team briefing the Honourable Home Minister, Mr. Ram Bahadur Thapa (Badal) on the earthquake safety tools and techniques at the earthquake exhibition stall at Rastriya Sabha Griha in Kathmandu

Thematic workshop organized by NRA as part of preparation to international conference in November 2020 :

NRA organized two thematic workshops in the month of January focusing on Livelihood and economic recovery (21 January) followed by Governance, Institutional Development, Financing Rescue and Relief (23 January), with the objective of identifying areas of research papers. The scientific papers will document earthquake lessons learned and good practices to share with national and international reconstruction stakeholders and wider audiences at large. During the thematic workshops , abstract papers were presented to explore broader framework on the potential topics. The workshop also aimed at discussing and finalizing thematic papers and potential writers with clear roles and responsibilities, including a timeline for the submission of research papers.



An update on Retrofit -Technical Working Group (R-TWG): The R-TWG organized series of mini-internal working sessions in the month of January to discuss and draft standard contents, session plans and standard communication for retrofit orientation program, including compiling and formatting norms for rate analysis. The working group is also compiling available Information, Education and Communication (IEC)/ Behaviour Change Communication (BCC) materials from different organizations to standardize IEC/BCC material on retrofitting for dissemination at the grassroots level. Partners are requested to contribute IEC/BCC promotional materials to this working group for compilation and can contact Laxmi Prasad Bhatta, National Technical Officer at techofficer.national@hrrpnepal.org

An update on Urban Technical Working Group (UR-TWG) : The UR-TWG is currently carrying out a qualitative and quantitative study in order to prioritize and strategize on urban recovery issues. The qualitative study is in the data collection stage, consisting of Focus Group Discussions and Key Informant Interviews in approximately 8-9 wards of various municipalities. Following the data analysis of this study, a questionnaire will be developed for a quantitative study to be carried out in February. The UR-TWG will carry out the quantitative survey in collaboration with NRA. In addition, the group is working in parallel on 4 identified urban recovery issues of finance, land, policy and socio-technical assistance (STA). The Working Group is seeking to expand its membership and requests interested POs, local governments and private sector stakeholders to contact sneha@hrrpnepal.org

Social Mobilizers Training as part of providing socio-technical assistance (STA) program in post-earthquake reconstruction, 27 January 2020:

CLPIU-Building jointly with the World Bank and with support from partner organizations, are finalizing a four-day social mobilization training curriculum. The training will focus on orienting and sensitizing social mobilizers on social mobilization aspects including NRA policies and guidelines. The CLPIU-Building, GMaLI, WB, NSET, HRRP and CRS have contributed in the development of training curricula including Resource Persons support. DLPIU-Building Offices are currently under the process of completing recruitment of social mobilizers by signing contractual agreement with all the social mobilizers in the 14 earthquake affected districts. For example, the Dhading DLPIU-Building Office published [a notice](#) for successful candidates on 8 November 2019 in accordance with the [social mobilizer and mobile mason recruitment policy guideline-2076](#). The successful candidates are contacting the DLPIU-Building Dhading Office for contract signing by 31 January 2020 (2076/10/09). They are requested to contact DLPIU Offices with personal documents consisting of an applicant form, copy of citizenship card, academic certificates including training certificates.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020: during this period district coordination meetings took place in Dolakha (5 & 14 Jan), Kathmandu (5 Jan), Lamjung (6 Jan), Sindhupalchok (7 Jan), Ramechhap (10 Jan), Makwanpur (16 Jan), Kavrepalanchok (19 Jan), Dhading (22-23 Jan). Municipal level meetings took place in municipalities and wards across Kathmandu, Kavrepalanchok, Kaski, Lalitpur, Lamjung, Makwanpur, Nuwakot, Okhaldhunga, Ramechhap, Sindhupalchok & Syangja. Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

In **Dolakha**, the district facilitation meetings decided to provide first tranche to **187** households who were not able to access the tranche within mid July 2019. Commitments were made in the ward offices that they will complete reconstruction within the NRA deadline. Similarly, additional **222** households were approved for the first tranche whose Partnership Agreements (PA) were submitted by the Municipal offices until mid January 2020. The meeting also decided to submit the list of households that have not done the PA till mid January 2020 to central NRA for necessary action.

In **Kathmandu**, the district facilitation meeting took place on 5 Jan 2020. The meeting decided to collect the details of each household that have not been able to start reconstruction due to land issues including vulnerable households, and those who have

not been able to access second and third tranches. The committee approved **280** households for the first tranche and **894** households for the second tranche. The meeting emphasized working in close coordination with municipal and ward authorities to get the details of the households and to find a way forward to expedite the reconstruction process and complete within the NRA deadline.

In **Lamjung**, the district facilitation meeting took place on 6 Jan 2020. The meeting approved to provide a second tranche to **254** HHs who were not able to receive within mid January 2020 and first tranche to 7 displaced households. These households have signed an agreement with their respective Ward/Municipal offices to complete the reconstruction within NRA deadline.

In **Sindhupalchok**, the meeting decided to disburse first tranche to **118** households and second tranche to **195** households. This decision was made as per the previous directive from NRA central about the tranche disbursement to be made before 15 Jan 2020 for first tranche and 12 Feb 2020 for second tranche respectively. **87** out of **167** landless HHs have received first tranche and they also have been recommended for additional grant of 200,000 NPR to purchase land. Furthermore, the committee proposed to seek assistance and recommendation in case of displaced beneficiaries who purchased land prior to 4 Feb 2019, and immediately after the earthquake to be eligible for the additional grant. However, few issues were reported, such as the land purchased by the beneficiary is in the name of a family member but not in the name of the beneficiary in the NRA list.

In **Ramechhap**, the partner organizations (POs) were requested to verify the households in their working areas in close coordination with ward offices and submit it to DLPIU GMaLI so as to avoid duplication in tranche and remove them from the Government reconstruction grant list. It was reported that many of the households in the district have received first and second tranche but have not completed the reconstruction. All the concerned stakeholders were requested to encourage these households to complete reconstruction, else to take necessary action including returning of both the tranches. Durable Solution was requested to complete the Detailed Project Report (DPR) of Duragaun integrated settlement and submit the report to GMaLI within January 2020 to move ahead with the reconstruction. It was noted that Build Change/UNOPS will select one model house to be retrofitted with full technical and material support from BC/UNOPS while five other houses will be retrofitted under partial support approach (70% by BC/UNOPS and 30% by home owner).

In **Makwanpur**, the meeting decided to provide the first tranche to **179** households and second tranche to **202** households who were not able to access the tranche within the NRA deadline, based on the verification and directive of NRA. The meeting also decided to provide the remaining tranche amount to **361** households who had already built their houses before the deployment of technical engineers in the field by NRA. A decision was made to collect the details of households who have not signed the partnership agreement and then submit it to NRA for necessary action.

In **Kavrepalanchok**, based on the commitment made by the people in their respective ward offices to complete reconstruction within the NRA deadline, **26** households have been approved for receiving first tranche and **370** households for the second tranche. Based on the meeting held on 10 Jan 2020, the list of households that had not received the first tranche were sent to ward offices for verification and clarification. Only files of 3 beneficiaries have been received which will be forwarded for disbursement of the first tranche.

In **Dhading**, district level coordination meeting decided to investigate the technical issues as well as issues related to banks where second and third tranche disbursement have been withheld for a long time period. The meeting also focused on the collection of the names of the beneficiaries who wish to convert from retrofitting to reconstruction at the ward level. Few discrepancies were reported in the tranche data sent from DLPIU Building and DLPIU GMaLI to the Financial Controller General Office. This was decided to be verified in the field and then the report was forwarded to DLPIU-GMaLI and DLPIU-Building. Another decision was to verify the duplication in beneficiaries and to initiate the process of removing them from the list. Ward offices were requested to send the details of the houses built before the deployment of technical engineers by NRA, for release of remaining tranche. Finally, a decision was made to notify the people who have not started reconstruction due to financial problems to seek loans under the loan support program of private housing reconstruction of NRA.

In **Kathmandu**, municipal level interaction and orientation programs were held in **Dakshinkali Municipality (30 Dec 2019)**, **Kirtipur Municipality (30 Dec 2019)**, **Gokarneshwor Municipality (31 Dec 2019)**, **Chandragiri Municipality (2 Jan 2020)** and **Nagarjun Municipality (7 Jan 2020)**. The discussions during the programs at all Municipalities were mainly focused on how to get the beneficiaries to complete the reconstruction and retrofitting work within the NRA deadline. Ward offices and Municipality agreed to support the NRA engineers to collect the details of each household including the ones that have not done the partnership agreement and those not applying for the second and third tranches. GMaLI requested the Ward and Municipality representatives to send the information after being verified by the Ward Grievance committee consisting of ward chief, ward secretary and one engineer. Similarly, any decisions made at the Municipal level in case of earthquake affected households were requested to be sent to DLPIU-GMaLI and District facilitation committee after being approved by the Municipal Executive Committee.

In **Ramechhap, Wards 4 & 5, Gokulganga Rural Municipality (15 & 17 Jan 2020)**, both the offices reported that none of the households under retrofit grant have signed the partnership agreement. **6** out of **60** HHs in ward 4 and **60** out of **114** HHs in ward 5 have demolished their houses and have started building new houses. Almost all of these retrofit HHs have applied to be switched to full reconstruction list. Some of these retrofit HHs were also noted to be in hazardous areas. Ward 5 Chief also reported some challenges in work due to frequent change of technical persons in the ward.

In **Kavrepalanchok, ward 9, Mandandeupur Municipality (13 Jan 2020)**, there are 11 households under the retrofit grant list. Many of these households have demolished the old houses and have applied to be included in the full reconstruction grant list. There are also households who are willing to retrofit their house provided they get technical assistance. One of the major reconstruction challenges in the ward is that people have houses in other places as well.

In **Sindhupalchok, Lisankhupakhar Rural Municipality (31 Dec 2019)**, the Municipal level “Retrofit Task Force” was formed, which was oriented by DSE of Sindhupalchok. In the meeting it was decided to conduct a door to door campaign to collect the details of retrofit households in the wards and sensitize the retrofit beneficiaries regarding the benefits of retrofitting. All the technical staff were requested to be present in their working area and report the reconstruction progress to their supervisor in a timely manner. A NRA focal engineer will maintain the reconstruction information and provide necessary support to the Municipality to smoothen the reconstruction process.

In **Makwanpur**, orientation programs on retrofitting were conducted in various wards of **Manahari Rural Municipality, Bagmati Rural Municipality and Bakaiya Rural Municipality (8 - 11 Jan 2020)**. The orientation focused on promoting the use of retrofitting in load bearing and timber-framed structure. The orientation targeted specific groups of masons and technical people involved in the process of reconstruction. Observations during the orientation found the crude need of OJT (On the Job Training) of retrofitting for masons working in the sector. Beneficiaries, masons and technicians were motivated, encouraged and advised on the tentative cost margin of the timber and load bearing structures upto one storey and attic.

In **Lalitpur, Ward 6, Mahalaxmi Municipality (9 Jan 2020)**, LUMANTI has supported 109 earthquake affected HHs to rebuild their houses and also provided an additional top-up support of 50,000 NPR. The ward office has been flexible and has taken ownership in providing services to the people who were struggling with reconstruction in absence of land ownership, through documentation and public enquiry deed processes. Many beneficiaries found the tranche process troublesome and time consuming because of which they are reluctant to start reconstruction. Many people also prefer to sell their private lands for reconstruction of their houses. Although they are aware of the loans provided by the financial institutions, they find the process difficult due to the collateral and the interest rates associated with it. The ward chief expressed concern regarding urban recovery in the ward with the stark transformation in reconstruction, from SMM/BMM to RCC structures and beyond. He said the Government should focus on preserving the traditional structures like traditional houses, bahas, bihis, paatis, sattal, temples and monuments. He emphasized on the need for socio-technical assistance and awareness among people on conservation of traditional heritage. The ward office has submitted an expression of interest to the Government of Nepal to include Sanagaun Siddhipur in the heritage site list.

In **Syangja, Ward 2, Aadhikhola Rural Municipality (24 Jan 2020)**, some of the challenges reported were difficulty in convincing the people on retrofitting. It was also reported that there is no engineer in the municipality. Hence sub-engineers and sub-assistant engineers were finding it difficult to recommend correction measures to non-compliant houses. New houses have been built in the ward, but old quake damaged houses have not been demolished. There were also concerns regarding the top-up support for vulnerable as vulnerable households have not received the additional 50,000 NPR.

In **Dhading, Ward 7, Dhunibesi Rural Municipality (17 Jan 2020) , Ward 5 & Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality (22 Jan 2020)**, the common decision made during the meetings were to start distribution of completion certificates to those households who have completed the reconstruction and also to initiate the process for the households that have received third tranche. In Jwalamukhi RM, where 165 people have been listed as vulnerable, the ward offices are to verify the list and send it to GMAI for the vulnerable households to get the 50,000 NPR top-up support. Similarly, there are 22 vulnerable households in Ward 7, Dhunibesi RM. 597 out of 1,110 retrofitting households in Jwalamukhi RM have received the first tranche. Build Change/UNOPS will start a model house retrofitting using splint and bandage technique in Ward 4 of Jwalamukhi RM. However, many of the retrofit households want to convert to full reconstruction.

**HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur, Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019
- 26 Jan 2020**



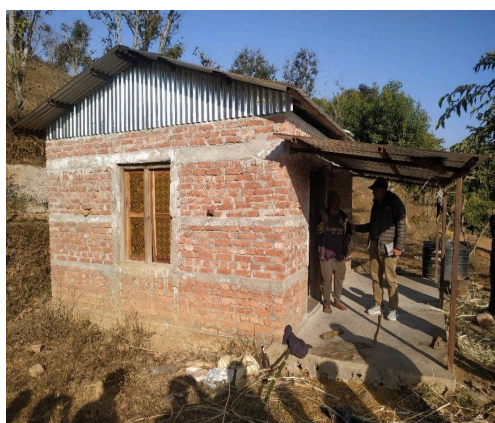
Ward 9, Suryabinayak Municipality, Lalitpur: the two-storied + attic house has been approved for retrofitting. The homeowner was suggested to remove the attic and conduct a retrofitting process by keeping wire mesh and jacketing in all major corners of the house by DSE.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020



Ward 8, Ramechhap Municipality, Ramechhap: two storey stone in mud mortar with attic. The house is currently being retrofitted by UNOPS/Build Change as a demo house.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020



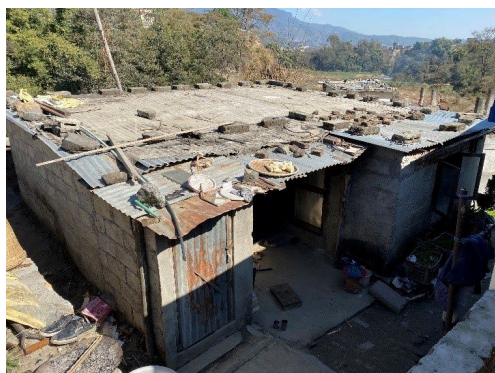
Ward 4, Jwalamukhi Rural Municipality, Dhading: one room, single storey, brick in cement mortar structure. The homeowner has received all tranches of Government grant. The homeowner was supported with Rs. 50,000/- worth of STA support (2 head masons till housing completion).

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020



Ward 8, Panchkhal Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: single storey, brick in cement mortar structure. The female Beneficiary Parbati Dawadi reconstructed her house by taking a loan from the cooperative. She has already received her third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu, Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020



Ward 2, Tarkeshwor Municipality, Kathmandu: single storey, block frame structure under retrofitting grant list. Some parts of the wall had fallen off during the earthquake and have been temporarily maintained. DSE suggested jacketing of the structure.

HRRP District Coordination Team Makwanpur, Chitwan, Nawalparasi Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020



Ward 5, Bagamati Rural Municipality, Makwanpur: Load bearing stone in mud mortar, RCC horizontal bands and vertical reinforcements have been provided. The house consists of 2 rooms and has a lightweight CGI sheet roof.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Rasuwa Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 – 26 Jan 2020



Ward 5, Suryagadhi Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: single storey, two room stone in cement mortar with attic. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the GoN.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung, Tanahun, Kaski, Syangja Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 –26 Jan 2020



Ward 2, Aadhi khola Rural Municipality, Syangja: one storey with attic, load bearing stone in mud mortar structure. The beneficiary has received the first tranche of the GON retrofitting housing grant. The house is circular in shape with one room.

HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 –26 Jan 2020



Ward 2, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: load bearing brick and cement masonry with two rooms and CGI roofing. The homeowner has received all tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Khotang, Solukhumbu, Monthly Report, 27 Dec 2019 –26 Jan 2020



Ward 10, Champadevi Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga: single storey with attic, two-roomed, stone in mud mortar house with wooden bands. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing reconstruction grant and completion certificate. The total cost of construction is 750,000 NPR.

CASE STUDIES

Featured Technical Staff Person, Mr. Sharwan KC, This month's featured technical staff person is Mr. Sharwan KC. He has been working as an NRA Engineer since April 2016. He is currently a focal engineer in Arghakhanchi district. Prior to this, he worked at Bhimeshwor Municipality, Dolakha and Chhatradev Rural Municipality in Arghakhanchi. He shares his experience working in both, the highly and moderately earthquake affected districts. He feels that the priority given to reconstruction by the local authorities and the level of awareness among the people is higher in Dolakha than Arghakhanchi. In Arghakhanchi, local authorities are less focused on reconstruction programs.

He is one of the few engineers who has been involved in the reconstruction work since the very beginning of the earthquake reconstruction programme launched by the Government of Nepal. He has been working in close coordination with numerous organizations in the districts for building not just earthquake resistant houses but also resilient communities.

He shares that retrofitting is one of the major challenges of reconstruction programs, particularly in the moderately earthquake affected districts where most of the households under retrofit grant have not started retrofitting even after receiving the first tranche. He said he has been trying to push the retrofitting work with high priority through the Retrofit Task Force formed in the district to orient the people on retrofitting techniques and its benefits. Being a focal engineer of the task force, he is also collecting details of the houses to identify if they are technically feasible to retrofit or not and at the same time conducting technical sessions on different retrofitting techniques.

He added that some people who are interested in retrofitting their houses have not been able to do so due to lack of knowledge and skilled masons available for carrying out the

retrofitting. Demonstration and training the masons on retrofitting would help people to understand and learn more on retrofitting techniques, and initiate the process.

He thinks that it's not only the people who are struggling with retrofitting but also the technical persons. We must first understand the needs of the people in reconstruction and properly communicate with them, said Sharwan. He believes that NRA should provide training to the technical staff in the district, which will not only help in enhancing the capacity of the technical persons but will also support communication and convince the people, which will add to the overall reconstruction process.

Hari Bahadur Thapa, of Baun Danda-13 in Syangja successfully retrofitted his house:

Mr. Hari Bahadur Thapa is from Ward No. 13, Baun Danda of Syangja district. His two storey load bearing stone in mud mortar (SMM) house that was partially damaged by the 2015 earthquake, has been successfully retrofitted with his own initiative. On top of that, it is the first house to be retrofitted in Syangja district – a moderately earthquake affected district, where there are no partner organizations supporting the reconstruction. This is one of the good examples of the owner driven retrofitting process in the country. Thanks to the DLPIU Building for providing technical support required to retrofit Hari's house successfully. As suggested by DLPIU, chicken wire mesh jacketing technique was used to retrofit Hari's house where some parts like heavy gable walls were dismantled and openings in the upper storey were closed to make the house resilient to earthquakes. The retrofitting of the house was completed in 28 days with three rooms in the first storey for the family purposes and second storey to store grains. Hari Bahadur spent NPR 332,000 to retrofit the house including both the materials and masons labor cost. Hari has received the first tranche of the Government retrofit grant and is awaiting to receive the second tranche.

Hari Bahadur and his family are very happy and feel secure in the retrofitted house. "My house is stronger and resilient to future earthquakes and now I can sleep without fear in the house", said Hari. He further added, "I am probably the first one to have retrofitted the house in the whole district and the district GMaLI office should in fact award us for that". He hopes that others in the community will follow his footsteps and retrofit their partially damaged houses.



Self-initiated Retrofitting in Sindhupalchok: Hira Bahadur Nepal, 47 years old lives in ward 7, Balefi Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok with his wife Urmila Nepal. The house is 1.5 storey, SMM structure and had minor cracks due to the 2015 earthquake.



In one of the field visits by DLPIU Building, GMaLI and HRRP, the team came to visit Hira's house that was undergoing retrofitting. Surprisingly, Hira Bahadur had started retrofitting the interior of his house using rebar jacketing on the three walls of the house. When the team asked how Hira got to know about the technique, he said he started the work simply by watching "Baliyo Ghar" program on Kantipur Television which shows and talks about reconstruction and retrofitting in the country after the 2015 earthquake. Hira Bahadur neither is educated nor has received any trainings on reconstruction/retrofitting. He did not even have any idea that he would be eligible to receive second tranche of the Government retrofit grant.



The way Hira was using the rebar jacketing was perfectly correct, the team remarked. Further, the team provided Hira technical guidance to apply jacketing on the outside walls of the house and the way to connect jacketing between interior and exterior walls and to apply micro concreting to make the house strong and resilient. The team also added, Hari Bahadur's skills could be helpful in other retrofitting works in the district.

Mrs. Eet Maya Nepali, listed under NRA vulnerable beneficiary of Bhimeshwor Municipality, ward no.8 in Dolakha completes her house reconstruction:



District Coordination Committee Chief Mr. Dabbal Pandey, Bhimeshwor Municipality Vice-Mayor Mrs. Kamala Basnet and UNDP staff Mr. Himal Ojha interacting with Vulnerable beneficiary. Photo: HRRP

Mrs. Eet Maya Nepali, a 70 year old, single woman, from Bhimeshwor Urban Municipality, Boch-8, Mane Dada is without education and has no source of income. She was mostly unaware about the earthquake reconstruction tranche release process. She was unsure if she could complete her house within the government grant of NPR 300,000.

She struggled to get help from the ward, neighbors and relatives but nobody came to her rescue. Given her dire situation, UNDP coordinated with the ward office in Boch in order to support a vulnerable beneficiary like her with economic difficulties. With support from European Union Civil Protection and Humanitarian Aid, UNDP provided in-kind reconstruction materials like cement and rebars worth RS. 50,000 including three days mason refresher training to support her reconstruction. UNDP provided a link between vulnerable beneficiaries and NRA technical persons for socio-technical assistance (STA) provided by NRA and partner organizations including Eet Maya. UNDP facilitated the NRA tranche release process, filling NRA forms and coordination services with concerned stakeholders.

The total cost of construction was NPR 550,000 including 300,000 government grant. With frequent monitoring and coordination with the local concerned stakeholders, the reconstruction work gained momentum. It took her 5 weeks to complete her house.

Most of the vulnerable beneficiaries like Eet Maya are unaware about the support they can get from the ward office and other organizations. The door-to-door staff mobilization from UNDP provides such beneficiaries with socio-technical support to take their reconstruction process forward. This includes support on layout and design of the house to ensure quality of work and cost estimation, coordination with NRA engineers for timely monitoring and proper documentation for the release of the tranches.

Eet Maya has received all three tranches of government grants now. She is happy that she will be getting a new roof over her head soon. “Due to my old age, I had been unable to construct my house on my own. Thanks to UNDP for motivating me and helping me rebuild my house”, she shares.



[Baliyo Ghar | Episode - 170 | 19 January 2019](#): NRA CEO, Mr. Sushil Gyewali, NDRRMA Authority CEO, Mr. Anil Pokhrel, including other representatives highlight the role of different entities in building resilient communities. This program was aired on Kantipur Television on 19 January 2020 at 6:30 & 10:00 PM. Kantipur TV airs this program every Sunday at 6:30 PM and Monday at 11:30 AM and 4:00 PM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

Monthly e-newsletter of National Reconstruction Authority December 2019

HRRP PRODUCTS



Palika Profiles (Municipal reconstruction profiles)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32-earthquake affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



Municipal dataset on Reconstruction

CSV, PDF

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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